

Places

Unit 3 of 12 · Grammar Study Sheet

Describe cities, talk about your job and routines using the present simple, and ask for directions.

What you will be able to do

- ✓ Tell the time
- ✓ Describe a town or city
- ✓ Talk about places of work
- ✓ Use the present simple
- ✓ Ask questions with the present simple
- ✓ Ask for and give directions

4 lessons in this unit

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Topics: describing cities · present simple (I/you/we/they)

Vocabulary — Describing cities

free	expensive ↔ cheap	popular	polluted
noisy ↔ quiet	crowded	modern ↔ old	beautiful ↔ ugly
clean ↔ dirty	big ↔ small	relaxing	

No-car zones — areas for people, bicycles and public transport only. Examples: London parks, Tokyo (Ginza), Bogotá, Melbourne (Bourke Street).

Present simple — I/you/we/they

Use the present simple for facts, routines and habits. With I/you/we/they, use the BASE form. Negative and question forms use the auxiliary "do".

+	I/you/we/they + base verb (have, live, like...)
–	I/you/we/they + don't + base verb
?	Do + I/you/we/they + base verb? — Yes, I do. / No, I don't.

Examples:

- I live in the city centre.
- We don't have a car. We go everywhere by bicycle.
- Do you like shopping? — Yes, I do. / No, I don't.
- Where do you live? — In the city centre.
- What time do you finish work? — At about three o'clock.

Topics: places of work · present simple (he/she/it) · -s endings

Vocabulary — Places of work

accountant — office	doctor — hospital	pilot — plane	sailor — ship/boat
teacher — classroom	sales assistant — shop	waiter — restaurant	

Pronunciation — -s endings: /s/, /z/, /ɪz/

The 3rd-person -s has THREE possible sounds depending on the final sound of the verb. M^o ti^{ng} Vi^{tt}: "sháng say, chi^u xⁿ, sung s^{ng}, zô" → /ɪz/; "Thⁱ Fong Kiⁿ Ph^{ng} Tây" → /s/; còn lⁱ → /z/.

- /ɪz/ — sh, s, ch, x, ss, z — torch → torches, bus → buses, class → classes, box → boxes, buzz → buzzes. M^o: "sháng say, chi^u xⁿ, sung s^{ng}, zô"
- /s/ — sau ph^{âm} vô thanh (t, f, k, p, th-vô-thanh): works, meets, starts, laughs — nh^{qua} "Thⁱ Fong Kiⁿ Ph^{ng} Tây"
- /z/ — m^c ^{nh} (sau âm h^u thanh ho^c nguyên âm): lives, goes, studies, travels, plays

Present simple — he/she/it

+	He/She/It + verb-s (works, has, does, studies)
–	He/She/It + doesn't + base verb
?	Does + he/she/it + base verb? — Yes, she does. / No, she doesn't.

- He works in a shop.
- She studies places under the sea.
- He has exams soon. (have → has)
- She doesn't live in London.
- Does he have children? — Yes, he does. / No, he doesn't.
- What does Beverly do? — She's a marine archaeologist.

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Vocabulary — Numbers — cardinal vs ordinal

Cardinal numbers tell quantity (how many). Ordinal numbers tell position (1st, 2nd, 3rd...). For 21+, only the LAST word becomes ordinal: 21st = twenty-first.

Most ordinals end in /θ/ ("th"). Exceptions: 1st, 2nd, 3rd.

- ### Wordbuilding — adjective + noun collocations

- first language (your native language)
- second language (one you learn later)
- official language (used by the government)
- native speaker (learned the language as a child)
- Over 1 billion speakers of Chinese — Mandarin is in 1st place.
- English is in 4th place as a first language.

Lesson 3d · Atlanta + city description + Cowley Road

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Topics: places in a city · giving directions · writing description · capital letters · video lesson · Oxford

Vocabulary — Places in a city (3d)

car park	museum	hotel	library
theatre	park	post office	aquarium
cinema	gym / sports centre	art gallery	visitor centre

Vocabulary — Video — Cowley Road, Oxford (3f)

post office	community	pre-schooler	medical centre
ingredients	traffic lights	mosque	sports centre
supermarket			

Real life — Giving directions (3d)

Useful phrases for asking where things are and giving directions.

Examples:

- Asking: Where is ...? / I'd like to go to ... / Is it near here?
- Distance: It's near here. / It's about ten minutes away.
- Go past the ... (past = alongside and beyond)
- Go across ... (cross to the other side)
- Go straight up ... (continue forward)
- Take the first street on the left/right. / Turn left. / Turn right.

Writing skill — Capital letters (3e)

In English, USE a capital letter for: start of sentence, the pronoun I, names of people/cities/places, countries/nationalities/languages, days/months, streets/parks/squares.

Examples:

- I'm from Australia. (start, pronoun I, country)
- I love Sydney. (city)
- I love the winter in Moscow.
- December is my favourite month. (month)
- On Saturdays I meet friends. (day)
- I go to Narrabeen Beach. (place)
- NO capital for: seasons (winter), parts of the day (evening).